Economy / Budget / Trade

> **Priority B, but rising** For February 2026, this file is one of the most important. Budget numbers are asked every year.

What to note every time

Ask yourself	Why
What is the deal or Budget item?	FTA, Survey, scheme outlay
What is the exact figure?	Lakh crore, percent, year
Who releases the data?	Budget speech, RBI, NSO
Any exception list?	Sensitive farm or industry items

January 2026

India–EU Free Trade Agreement talks finished | 27 January 2026

What happened India and the European Union announced that they had finished FTA negotiations during the India–EU leaders' meeting in New Delhi.

What you should remember

- This is a trade deal between India and the EU bloc.
- Official messages called it India's largest FTA of this kind.
- Talks finished does **not** mean the deal is already law. Signing and approval steps remain.
- Public briefings spoke of deep tariff cuts on many industrial goods, with care for sensitive sectors such as dairy and some auto items.
- From the same visit, **RBI** and Europe's **ESMA** signed a markets cooperation MoU.
- Political and defence outcomes of the same visit are written in detail under International.

Farm scheme money proposal

- A proposal to merge major farm schemes under **PM-RKVY** spoke of about **₹1.75 lakh crore** over five years.
- Full scheme card → Schemes.

February 2026

Union Budget 2026–27 | Presented 1 February 2026

What happened Union Minister for Finance and Corporate Affairs **Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman** presented the Union Budget 2026–27 in Parliament on **1 February 2026**. Anchored in the new **Kartavya Bhawan**, the Budget was framed around **Yuva Shakti** and structured under **Three Kartavyas**: 1. **Kartavya 1**: Faster and resilient growth by raising productivity and competitiveness amid global volatility. 2. **Kartavya 2**: Build people's capacities so citizens become partners in prosperity. 3. **Kartavya 3**: Inclusive access to resources and opportunities under **Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas**.

Budget at a Glance (Master Financial Table — ₹ Crore)

Component	2024–25 Actuals	2025–26 (BE)	2025–26 (RE)	2026–27 (BE)
1. Revenue Receipts	₹30,36,619	₹34,20,409	₹33,42,323	**₹35,33,150**
- Tax Revenue (Net to Centre)	₹25,00,039	₹28,37,409	₹26,74,661	**₹28,66,922**
- Non-Tax Revenue	₹5,36,580	₹5,83,000	₹6,67,662	**₹6,66,228**
2. Capital Receipts	₹16,16,249	₹16,44,936	₹16,22,519	**₹18,14,165**

Component	2024–25 Actuals	2025–26 (BE)	2025–26 (RE)	2026–27 (BE)
- Recovery of Loans	₹24,617	₹29,000	₹30,190	**₹38,397**
- Other Receipts (Disinvestment)	₹17,202	₹47,000	₹33,837	**₹80,000**
- Borrowings & Other Liabilities	₹15,74,431	₹15,68,936	₹15,58,492	**₹16,95,768**
Total Receipts (1 + 2)	₹46,52,867	₹50,65,345	₹49,64,842	**₹53,47,315**
Total Expenditure	₹46,52,867	₹50,65,345	₹49,64,842	**₹53,47,315**
- On Revenue Account	₹36,00,914	₹39,44,255	₹38,69,087	**₹41,25,494**
- Of which: Interest Payments	₹11,15,575	₹12,76,338	₹12,74,338	**₹14,03,972**
- Grants for creation of Capital Assets	₹2,72,656	₹4,27,192	₹3,08,151	**₹4,92,702**
- On Capital Account (Public Capex)	₹10,51,953	₹11,21,090	₹10,95,755	**₹12,21,821**
Effective Capital Expenditure	₹13,24,609	₹15,48,282	₹14,03,906	**₹17,14,523**

Deficit Statistics & Public Debt Path (% of GDP)

Deficit Indicator	2024–25 Actuals	2025–26 (BE)	2025–26 (RE)	2026–27 (BE)	% of GDP (2026–27 BE)
Fiscal Deficit	₹15,74,431	₹15,68,936	₹15,58,492	**₹16,95,768**	**4.3%**
Revenue Deficit	₹5,64,296	₹5,23,846	₹5,26,764	**₹5,92,344**	**1.5%**
Effective Revenue Deficit	₹2,91,640	₹96,654	₹2,18,613	**₹99,642**	**0.3%**
Primary Deficit	₹4,58,856	₹2,92,598	₹2,84,154	**₹2,91,796**	**0.7%**

- **Centre's Outstanding Debt**: Estimated at **55.6% of GDP in 2026–27** (down from pandemic peak of 61% in 2020–21; long-term fiscal glide path targets **50% ± 1% by March 2031**).
- **Nominal GDP Growth Assumption**: Budget projects **10.0% nominal GDP growth** for FY 2026–27.

Rupee Flows (Where It Comes From & Where It Goes)

Rupee Comes From (2026–27 BE): 1. **Borrowings and Other Liabilities**: **24%** (Single largest receipt source) 2. **Income Tax**: **21%** 3. **Corporation Tax**: **18%** 4. **Goods and Services Tax (GST) & Other Taxes**: **15%** 5. **Non-Tax Revenue**: **10%** 6. **Union Excise Duties**: **6%** 7. **Customs**: **4%** 8. **Non-Debt Capital Receipts**: **2%**

(High-Yield Sequence Trap: Borrowings 24% > Income Tax 21% > Corporation Tax 18% > GST 15% > Non-Tax 10% > Excise 6% > Customs 4% > Non-Debt Capital 2%).

Rupee Goes To (2026–27 BE): 1. **States' Share of Taxes & Duties**: **22%** (Single largest outflow) 2. **Interest Payments**: **20%** 3. **Central Sector Schemes**: **17%** 4. **Defence**: **11%** 5. **Centrally Sponsored Schemes (CSS)**: **8%** 6. **Finance Commission & Other Transfers**: **7%** 7. **Other Expenditure**: **7%** 8. **Major Subsidies**: **6%** 9. **Civil Pensions**: **2%**

Detailed Sectoral Allocations & Flagship Programmes

1. Strategic Manufacturing & Industry (Kartavya 1): - **Biopharma SHAKTI**: **₹10,000 crore (over 5 years)** to build India as a global biologics hub; sets up **3 new NIPERs**, upgrades **7 existing NIPERs**, and accredits **1,000+ clinical trial sites**. - **India Semiconductor Mission 2.0 (Semicon 2.0)**: Outlay of **₹1,27,500 crore** for full-stack IP, semiconductor equipment, and supply-chain development. - **Electronics Components Manufacturing Scheme**: Outlay raised to **₹40,000 crore**. - **Rare Earth Corridors**: Dedicated extraction and processing corridors announced in **Odisha, Kerala, Andhra Pradesh, and Tamil Nadu**. - **Container Manufacturing Scheme**: Outlay of **₹10,000+ crore (over 5 years)**. - **Chemical Parks**: 3 modern Chemical Parks on a challenge-mode, cluster plug-and-play model. - **Legacy Industrial Clusters**: Scheme to modernize and revive **200 legacy industrial clusters**. - **SME Growth Fund**: **₹10,000 crore** fund to create "Champion SMEs"; Self-Reliant India Fund topped up by **₹2,000 crore**.

2. Infrastructure, Logistics & Connectivity: - **Public Capital Expenditure**: Raised to record **₹12.22 lakh crore** (effective capex: **₹17.15 lakh crore**). - **Interest-Free 50-Year Loans to States for Capex**: Raised to **₹1,85,000 crore** (up from ₹1.44 lakh crore). - **Dedicated Freight Corridor (DFC)**: Greenfield freight corridor from **Dankuni (West Bengal) to Surat (Gujarat)**. - **20 New National Waterways**: Operationalisation over 5 years, commencing with **NW-5 in Odisha**. - **Inland Ship Repair Hubs**: Dedicated ship-repair and regional training ecosystems at **Varanasi** and **Patna**. - **Coastal Cargo Promotion Scheme**: Aim to increase

coastal/waterways cargo share from **6% to 12% by 2047**. - **Seven High-Speed Rail Corridors**: 1. Mumbai–Pune, 2. Pune–Hyderabad, 3. Hyderabad–Bengaluru, 4. Hyderabad–Chennai, 5. Chennai–Bengaluru, 6. **Delhi–Varanasi**, 7. **Varanasi–Siliguri**. - **City Economic Regions (CERs)**: **₹5,000 crore per CER (5 years)** via reform-cum-results challenge funding.

3. Human Capital, Orange Economy & Social Priorities (Kartavya 2 & 3): - **AVGC Labs (Orange Economy)**: Setting up Content Creator Labs in **15,000 schools and 500 colleges** linked to **Indian Institute of Creative Technologies (IICT), Mumbai**. - **Allied Healthcare**: Training and certification of **1,00,000 Allied Health Professionals (AHP)** over 5 years. - **Medical Hubs & AYUSH**: **5 Regional Medical Hubs** for medical tourism; **3 new All India Institutes of Ayurveda**. - **Mental Health**: Establishing **NIMHANS-2** in North India; upgrading mental health institutes at **Ranchi** and **Tezpur**. - **Five University Townships**: Planned near major industrial and logistics corridors. - **Bharat-VISTAAR**: Multilingual agricultural AI tool integrating AgriStack with ICAR scientific practice packages. - **Divyangjan Kaushal Yojana**: Specialised skilling in IT, AVGC, hospitality, and food processing. - **Tourism Heritage**: Cultural and infrastructure push across **15 archaeological sites**; training **10,000 tourist guides**. - **16th Finance Commission Grants**: **₹1.4 lakh crore** provided for FY 2026–27.

4. Ministry & Subsidy Expenditure Distribution: - **Ministry of Defence**: **₹7.85 lakh crore** (**15% of total Union Budget** — highest single ministerial allocation; capital outlay for defence services: **₹2,19,306 crore**, a +17.6% rise). - **Ministry of Road Transport & Highways**: **6%**. - **Ministry of Railways**: **5%**. - **Ministry of Home Affairs**: **5%**. - **Total Subsidies**: **₹4,54,773 crore** (Food subsidy: **₹2,27,629 crore**; Fertiliser subsidy: **₹1,70,799 crore** — together constituting **87% of total subsidies**). - **Top Flagship Scheme Allocation**: **VB-G RAM G** allocated **₹95,692 crore** (highest single scheme outlay; transition MGNREGS allocation: ₹30,000 crore).

Major Tax Reforms & Proposals (Union Budget 2026–27)

- **Cloud Data Centres Tax Holiday to 2047**: 100% tax holiday granted until the year **2047** for foreign companies providing global cloud services using Indian data centres (subject to routing through Indian resellers).
- **IFSC / GIFT City Tax Holiday Doubled**: Extended from **10 years to 20 years** for IFSC units and Offshore Banking Units, with a concessional 15% rate applicable thereafter.
- **Minimum Alternate Tax (MAT) Rationalisation**: Corporate MAT rate reduced from **15% to 14%**; MAT credit accumulation discontinued from April 2026.
- **TCS Relief**: Tax Collected at Source (TCS) on overseas education remittances, medical treatments, and tour packages slashed to **2%**.
- **Share Buyback Taxation Overhaul**: Buybacks taxed as capital gains; additional buyback tax levied on promoters raising effective tax to **22% for corporate promoters and 30% for non-corporate promoters**.
- **Securities Transaction Tax (STT)**: Calibrated upward revision on futures and options (F&O) contracts.
- **Foreign Assets Disclosure Scheme 2026**: Introduced for small taxpayers, providing graded relief and immunity upon voluntary declaration.
- **FDI / Portfolio Liberalisation**: Persons Resident Outside India (PROI) allowed to invest up to **10%** in listed Indian companies under the Portfolio Investment Scheme.

Economic Survey 2025–26 | Comprehensive Master Analysis

Overview & Philosophy The **Economic Survey 2025–26** was presented in Parliament by Union Finance Minister **Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman**, prepared by the Economic Division of the Department of Economic Affairs under the leadership of Chief Economic Adviser (CEA) **Dr. V. Anantha Nageswaran**.

- **Reorganised Architecture:** Structured into **17 chapters** by depth and time-relevance (broadened and longer than prior editions), featuring dedicated special essays on: 1. **Artificial Intelligence** (opportunities and risks for labour markets); 2. **Quality of Life in Indian Cities** (urbanisation, mobility, and liveability); 3. **State Capacity and Private Sector Strategic Resilience** (building indispensable national capabilities).
- **Core Framing — "Marathon and Sprint":** Balancing long-term structural growth and resilience (*the marathon*) with agile short-term shock absorption and stabilization (*the sprint*).
- **Paradigm Shift — The "Entrepreneurial State":** Urges a transition from compliance-driven regulation to capability-driven **entrepreneurial policymaking** under global uncertainty. An Entrepreneurial State acts early, structures risks, learns through experimentation, and adapts dynamically without paralysis.
- **Three Global Scenarios for 2026:** 1. *Managed disorder*; 2. *Disorderly multipolar breakdown*; 3. *Low-probability high-impact shock cascade* (worse than the 2008 Global Financial Crisis).

- Across all scenarios, India is relatively better placed due to its large domestic market, less financialised growth model, strong reserves, and credible strategic autonomy.
- Prescribes **strategic sobriety over defensive pessimism**: supply stability, strategic buffers, diversified trade routes, and alternative payment architectures.
- Emphasises that India's scale (**145 crore population**) and vibrant democracy make copying external development blueprints unrealistic.

---

1. Macroeconomic Snapshot & Sectoral Performance

Macro Indicator	Metric / Projection	High-Yield Prelims Details
Real GDP Growth (FY 2025–26 FAE)	**7.4%**	First Advance Estimates; GVA growth at **7.3%**; 4th consecutive year as the world's fastest-growing major economy.
Real GDP Projection (FY 2026–27)	**6.8% – 7.2%**	Medium-term potential growth assessed at around **7%**.
Private Final Consumption Expenditure (PFCE)	**61.5% of GDP**	Rose by **7.0%** in FY26; highest share since 2012 (matched in FY23); powered by low inflation, steady jobs, and real wage gains.
Gross Fixed Capital Formation (GFCF)	**~30% of GDP**	Grew by **7.8%** in FY26; driven by sustained public capex and nascent private investment revival.
Services Sector GVA Growth	**9.3% in H1 FY26**	Estimated at **9.1%** for full FY26; primary growth engine. Share in GDP: **53.6%**; share in GVA: **56.4%** in H1 FY26.
Industrial & Manufacturing GVA	**7.0% in H1 FY26**	Manufacturing GVA accelerated from **7.72% in Q1** to **9.13% in Q2 FY26**.
Sovereign Rating Upgrades	**3 upgrades in 2025**	Upgraded by **Morningstar DBRS**, **S&P Global Ratings** (to 'BBB' — India's first S&P upgrade in 18 years), and **R&I**.

---

2. Fiscal Developments & Revenue Metrics

- **Centre's Revenue Receipts:** Rose to **9.2% of GDP in FY25 (Provisional Actuals)**, up from an average of ~8.5% during FY16–FY20.
- **Non-Corporate Tax Collections:** Structurally expanded from ~2.4% of GDP pre-pandemic to **3.3% of GDP post-pandemic**.
- **Direct Tax Base Widening:** Income Tax Returns (ITR) filed increased dramatically from **6.9 crore (FY22) to 9.2 crore (FY25)**.
- **Gross GST Collections:** Stood at **₹17.4 lakh crore** during April–December 2025 (+6.7% YoY growth); e-way bill generation surged by **21% YoY**.
- **Effective Capital Expenditure:** Reached **4.0% of GDP in FY25** (vs. 2.7% pre-pandemic).
- **SASCI Impact:** States maintained capital spending at ~**2.4% of GDP** via the Special Assistance to States for Capital Expenditure scheme.
- **Combined State Fiscal Deficit:** Edged up to **3.2% of GDP in FY25** (from ~2.8% post-pandemic).
- **Public Debt Trajectory:** General government debt-to-GDP ratio reduced by **7.1 percentage points** since 2020 peak.

---

3. Monetary Management & Financial Intermediation

- **Banking Asset Quality (SCBs):**
- Gross Non-Performing Assets (GNPA): Plunged to **2.2%** as of September 2025 (multi-decadal low).
- Net Non-Performing Assets (NNPA): Declined to **0.5%** as of September 2025 (historic record low).
- **Credit Growth:** Outstanding credit of Scheduled Commercial Banks rose **14.5% YoY** as of 31 December 2025 (up from 11.2% in Dec 2024).
- **Financial Inclusion (PMJDY):**
- Total bank accounts opened: **55.02 crore** (as of March 2025).
- Rural and semi-urban accounts: **36.63 crore** (>66%).
- **Capital Markets & Retail Deepening:**
- Unique equity investors crossed **12 crore** (September 2025), with nearly **25% being women**.
- Total demat accounts crossed **21.6 crore** (adding 235 lakh demat accounts during FY26 till Dec 2025).
- Unique mutual fund investors expanded to **5.9 crore** (December 2025), driven strongly by non-tier I and tier II/III cities.

- **Regulatory Stress Resilience:** The joint **IMF–World Bank Financial Sector Assessment Program (FSAP 2025)** validated the resilience, regulatory depth, and diversification of the Indian financial architecture.

---

4. External Sector & International Trade

- **Global Trade Footprint:**
- India's share of **global merchandise exports** nearly doubled from **1.0% (2005) to 1.8% (2024)**.
- India's share of **global commercial services exports** more than doubled from **2.0% (2005) to 4.3% (2024)**.
- India is the **world's 7th largest services exporter**.
- **Export Totals (FY25):**
- Total Exports: Record **USD 825.3 billion** (+6.1% YoY).
- Services Exports: Record high of **USD 387.6 billion** (+13.6% YoY).
- Over **80% of total FDI inflows** during FY23–FY25 went into services.
- **Global Remittances Leader:** India remained the **world's #1 recipient of remittances**, receiving **USD 135.4 billion in FY25**, which significantly buffered the merchandise trade deficit.
- **Current Account Deficit (CAD):** Remained moderate and sustainable at around **1.3% of GDP** in Q2 FY26.
- **Foreign Exchange Reserves:** Touched **USD 701.4 billion** (as of 16 January 2026), providing **~11 months of import cover** and covering over **94% of India's external debt**.
- **Foreign Direct Investment (FDI):**
- Gross FDI inflows reached **USD 64.7 billion** (April–November 2025).
- Greenfield Investments: India ranked **4th globally** in Greenfield announcements (2024) and emerged as the **#1 destination worldwide for Greenfield digital investments (2020–24)**.

---

5. Inflation Dynamics

- **Record Headline Disinflation:** India recorded its **lowest headline CPI inflation since the inception of the CPI series**, averaging **1.7% during April–December 2025**.
- **Drivers:** Primarily driven by sharp deflation/moderation in food and fuel prices, which jointly constitute **52.7% of the CPI basket**.
- **Global Standing:** Among major Emerging Markets and Developing Economies (EMDEs), India achieved one of the sharpest disinflations, with headline CPI falling by **1.8 percentage points in 2025 over 2024**.

---

6. Agriculture, Food Management & Rural Economy

- **Total Foodgrain Production:** Estimated at **3,577.3 LMT (357.73 MT)** in AY 2024–25 (+254.3 LMT increase over prior year, led by rice, wheat, and coarse cereals).
- **Horticulture Revolution:** Production reached **362.08 MT** in 2024–25 (contributing ~33% of agricultural GVA), **decisively surpassing total foodgrain production**!
- **Allied Sectors Surge:**
- Livestock GVA rose by nearly **195%** between FY15 and FY24.
- Fish production expanded by over **140%** between 2014 and 2024.
- **Digital Agri Platforms & Subsidies:**
- **e-NAM:** Onboarded **1.79 crore farmers**, **2.72 crore traders**, and **4,698 FPOs** across **1,522 regulated mandis** (by 31 December 2025).
- **PM-KISAN:** Disbursed over **₹4.09 lakh crore** directly to farmer accounts.
- **PM-KMY (Kisan Maandhan):** Enrolled **24.92 lakh farmers**.
- **SVAMITVA:** Completed drone mapping surveys across **3.28 lakh villages**; scaled livelihood training through **Drone Didis**.

---

7. Industry, Infrastructure & Technology

- **Production-Linked Incentive (PLI):** Operational across **14 sectors**; attracted **₹2.0 lakh crore** in actual investment, generated **₹18.7 lakh crore** in incremental production, and created over **12.6 lakh jobs**.
- **India Semiconductor Mission (ISM):** Advanced with **10 approved projects** involving **₹1.60 lakh crore** cumulative investment across 6 states.

- **Capital Expenditure Quantum:** Central government capex multiplied **4.2 times** from ₹2.63 lakh crore (FY18) to **₹11.21 lakh crore in FY26 (BE)**; effective capex reached **₹15.48 lakh crore**.
- **National Highways:** Network expanded by **~60% since FY14**; high-speed 4/6/8-lane expressways increased **nearly 10-fold**.
- **Indian Railways:** Route network reached **69,439 route km**, achieving **99.1% electrification**, with 3,500 km new additions targeted in FY26.
- **Civil Aviation:** India emerged as the **world's 3rd largest domestic aviation market**; operational airports jumped from **74 (2014) to 164 (2025)**.
- **Power & Energy Transition:**
- Historic turnaround: Power DISCOMs posted a aggregate **positive PAT of ₹2,701 crore** in FY25.
- Renewable energy accounts for **nearly 50% of total installed capacity**.
- Capacity added in FY26 (till Dec 2025): **38.61 GW of renewables**, led by **30.16 GW of solar power**.
- **Telecom & Digital:** 5G services cover **>99.9% of all districts**; overall tele-density reached **86.76%**; rural tap water coverage under Jal Jeevan Mission crossed **81%**.
- **Space Tech:** India became the **4th nation in the world** to achieve autonomous space docking capability (**SpaDeX**).

---

8. Social Infrastructure, Human Development & Employment

- **School Education:** Operates one of the world's largest schooling networks, serving **24.69 crore students** across **14.71 lakh schools**. Gross Enrolment Ratios (GER): **90.9%** (Primary), **90.3%** (Upper Primary), and **78.7%** (Secondary).
- **Higher Education Expansion:** Expanded to **70,018 institutions** (including **23 IITs, 21 IIMs, and 20 AIIMS**), alongside international offshore campuses (**IIT Zanzibar** in Tanzania and **IIT Delhi-Abu Dhabi** in UAE). Implementation of National Credit Framework (NCrF) and Academic Bank of Credits (ABC).
- **Health Indicators:**
- Maternal Mortality Ratio (MMR): **-86% decline** since 1990.
- Under-Five Mortality Rate (U5MR): **-78% decline** since 1990.
- Infant Mortality Rate (IMR): **-37% decline** over the past decade (down from 40 per 1,000 live births in 2013 to **25 in 2023**).
- **Employment & Skilling:**
- Total employment reached **56.2 crore** in Q2 FY26.
- Organised manufacturing employment grew **6% in FY24**, adding over **10 lakh jobs**.
- Formal recognition of gig and platform workers under Labour Codes; **e-Shram** portal registered over **31 crore workers**, with women constituting **54%**.
- **National Career Service (NCS):** Mobilised ~**80 million vacancies**.
- Proposed upgradation of **1,000 ITIs** to align with Industry 4.0.
- **Poverty Reduction:** As per the revised **World Bank international poverty line ($2.15/day)**, India's extreme poverty plummeted to **5.3% in 2022–23**.
- **Social Services Spending:** Government expenditure on social services rose to **7.9% of GDP in FY26 (BE)**.

> **Survey vs Budget Common Pitfalls**

1. **GDP Growth:** FAE estimated FY26 Real GDP at **7.4%** (Survey); Budget projected FY27 Nominal GDP at **10.0%**.
2. **Horticulture vs Foodgrain:** In AY 2024–25, horticulture output (**362.08 MT**) was **higher** than total foodgrain output (**357.73 MT**).
3. **CPI Series Record:** 1.7% (Apr–Dec 2025) is the **lowest headline CPI** since the CPI series started.
4. **Forex Cover:** USD 701.4B covers **~11 months of imports** and **>94% of external debt** (not 100%).

Uttar Pradesh Budget

- UP's own Budget size is about **₹9.13 lakh crore**.
- Full state card → UP Special.

March 2026

RELIEF scheme for exporters | about ₹497 crore

What happened Conflict risk in West Asia hurt shipping and insurance for exporters. The government announced the **RELIEF** package to keep exports moving.

Core facts

- Name: **RELIEF** (Resilience and Logistics Intervention for Export Facilitation).
- Size: about **₹497 crore**.
- Nodal body often named: **ECGC**.
- Full easy card → Schemes.

New Income Tax rules window

From **1 April 2026**, the new Income Tax Act framework begins. March coverage also spoke about new procedural rules, including clearer "Tax Year" language and revised education/hostel allowance figures in explainers. Fact exact allowance numbers from an official tax note before mocks.

Aviation money

- Modified **UDAN** outlay about **₹28,840 crore** for **2026–2036**.

April 2026

Nutrient Based Subsidy | Kharif 2026

What happened Cabinet approved NBS rates for **P&K** fertilisers for Kharif 2026.

Core facts

- Outlay: about **₹41,533–41,534 crore**.
- Window: **1 April to 30 September 2026**.
- Full card → Schemes.

Census funding fact

- Census 2027 outlay noted: about **₹11,718 crore**.

Trade / CEPA follow-up

- India–Korea summit spoke of reviewing the **CEPA** (in force since 2010). Details → International.

May 2026

Cabinet money cluster

- **SARTHAK-PDS:** about **₹25,530 crore** over five years.
- **ECLGS 5.0:** about **₹2.55 lakh crore** additional credit target.
- **Coal / lignite gasification scheme:** about **₹37,500 crore**.
- **Cotton Productivity Mission:** about **₹5,659 crore**.
- Full cards → Schemes.

Sugar export ban

What happened DGFT placed all categories of sugar (raw, white, refined) under the **Prohibited** export category until **30 September 2026**.

Why in news

- Fear of weak monsoon / **El Niño** stress on later sugar planting.
- Aim: protect domestic prices and supply.

Henley Passport Index

India around **rank 78**; Singapore at the top. Details → Indices.

June 2026

India–Oman CEPA in force

- Trade partnership with **Oman** started around **1–2 June 2026**.
- Explainers put duty-free access near **99%** of Indian export trade value.
- Full card → International.

VB-G RAM G money fact

- Centre allocation noted: about **₹95,692 crore**.
- Total with states: over about **₹1.5 lakh crore** in FY27 coverage.
- Full scheme card → Schemes.

Jewar / aviation economy

- Phase-1 project cost often noted around **₹11,200 crore**.
- Commercial ops from **15 June 2026**.
- Full UP card → UP Special.

Soft MSME day

World MSME Day is **27 June**. Theme in coverage: Empowering MSMEs through Innovation and Sustainable Industrial Development.

MoSPI Provisional Estimates of Annual GDP 2025–26 | Released 5 June 2026

What happened On **5 June 2026**, the Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation (MoSPI) released the *Provisional Estimates of Annual Gross Domestic Product (GDP) for the Financial Year 2025–26* alongside Quarterly GDP Estimates for Q4 (January–March 2026).

Core Growth & Absolute Numbers - **Real GDP Growth (2025–26)**: Estimated at **7.7%** (rose from ₹299.89 lakh crore in 2024–25 to **₹323.12 lakh crore** in 2025–26 at constant 2011–12 prices). - **Nominal GDP Growth (2025–26)**: Estimated at **8.9%** (rose from ₹318.07 lakh crore in 2024–25 to **₹346.36 lakh crore** in 2025–26). - **Real GVA Growth**: **7.9%** (₹294.91 lakh crore vs ₹273.36 lakh crore in 2024–25). - **Nominal GVA Growth**: **9.1%** (₹314.87 lakh crore vs ₹288.54 lakh crore in 2024–25). - **Q4 2025–26 Growth**: Real GDP grew by **7.8%** (reaching ₹87.77 lakh crore).

Indicator	2024–25	2025–26 (Provisional)	Growth Rate
Real GDP (Constant Prices)	₹299.89 lakh cr	**₹323.12 lakh cr**	**7.7%**
Nominal GDP (Current Prices)	₹318.07 lakh cr	**₹346.36 lakh cr**	**8.9%**
Real GVA (Constant Prices)	₹273.36 lakh cr	**₹294.91 lakh cr**	**7.9%**
Nominal GVA (Current Prices)	₹288.54 lakh cr	**₹314.87 lakh cr**	**9.1%**

Sectoral Performance (Growth at Constant Prices) - **Manufacturing**: **10.7%** (strongest industrial surge). - **Trade, Hotels, Transport, Communication & Broadcasting**: **10.9%** (leading services engine). - **Construction**: **7.4%**. - **Agriculture, Livestock, Forestry and Fishing**: **3.0%**.

Composition of Nominal GVA (2025–26) - Agriculture, Livestock, Forestry and Fishing: **18%** - Manufacturing: **15%** - Trade, Hotels, Transport, Communication & Broadcasting: **14%** - Construction: **8%**

Per Capita Indicators (2025–26) - **At Constant (2011–12) Prices**: - Per Capita GDP: **₹2,27,447** - Per Capita GNI: **₹2,24,307** - Per Capita NNI: **₹1,93,480** - Per Capita PFCE: **₹1,26,660** - **At Current Prices**: - Per Capita GDP: **₹2,43,803** - Per Capita GNI: **₹2,40,769** - Per Capita NNI: **₹2,08,090** - Per Capita GNDI: **₹2,49,195** - Per Capita PFCE: **₹1,38,324**

Demand-Side Shares in GDP (Constant Prices) - Private Final Consumption Expenditure (PFCE): **55.7%** (dominant driver). - Gross Fixed Capital Formation (GFCF / Investment rate): **32.3%**. - Government Final Consumption Expenditure (GFCE): **10.1%**. -

Exports of Goods & Services: **22.2%**. - Imports of Goods & Services: **23.7%**.

National Health Accounts (NHA) Estimates 2022–23

What happened The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare published the *National Health Accounts Estimates for India (2022–23)*, structured under the global *System of Health Accounts 2011 (SHA 2011)* framework.

High-Yield UPPCS Prelims Health Metrics - **Total Health Expenditure (THE)**: **₹8,81,359 crore**, constituting **3.37% of GDP**. - **Per Capita Total Health Expenditure**: **₹6,373**. - **Current Health Expenditure (CHE)**: ₹7,66,814 crore (**87.00%** of THE); **Capital Expenditure**: ₹1,14,545 crore (**13.00%** of THE). - **Government Health Expenditure (GHE)**: **₹3,85,332 crore** (**43.72% of THE**, accounting for **1.48% of GDP**). Per capita GHE: **₹2,786**. - **Out-of-Pocket Expenditure (OOPE)**: **₹3,82,629 crore** (**43.41% of THE**). Per capita OOPE: **₹2,767**. - **Historical Paradigm Shift (Crucial Trap)**: **Government Health Expenditure (43.72%) now officially surpasses Household Out-of-Pocket Expenditure (43.41%)**, reversing decades of private out-of-pocket dominance! - **Private Health Insurance**: ₹81,012 crore (**9.19%** of THE). - **Pharmaceutical Spending**: Accounts for **29.6%** of Current Health Expenditure. - **AYUSH / Alternative Medicine**: Accounts for **3.5%** of CHE. - **Expenditure by Level of Care**: - Primary Care: ~**46%** of CHE - Secondary Care: ~**34%** of CHE - Tertiary Care: ~**15%** of CHE - *Within Government Health Spending alone, Primary Healthcare commands 51% of public funds.*

Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC) Completes 10 Years (2016–2026)

What happened The **Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016** marked its **10th anniversary milestone in 2026**, successfully shifting India from a protracted, liquidation-centric recovery regime to a time-bound corporate revival framework.

Cumulative Resolution & Recovery Data (as of 31 March 2026) - Total cases admitted under IBC: **8,987 cases**. - Cases closed: **7,102 cases** (with **4,099 companies successfully rescued and revived**). - Approved resolution plans: **1,419 cases**. - Creditor Realisation: Facilitated cumulative realisation of **more than ₹4 lakh crore** for financial and operational creditors. - Fair Value Recovery: Creditors recovered approximately **95% of the fair value** of distressed corporate assets. - Liquidation Value Multiplier: Realisations represented **167% of the liquidation value**, conclusively proving that resolution preserves substantially greater enterprise value than liquidation. - **Gross NPA Ratio Impact**: Gross NPA ratio of Scheduled Commercial Banks (SCBs) dropped to a multi-year low of **2.15%** in September 2025. - **Dominance of IBC in Legal Recoveries**: In FY 2024–25, SCBs recovered **₹1,04,400 crore** across all recovery mechanisms (SARFAESI, DRTs, Lok Adalats, IBC) — of which **52.4% was recovered through IBC alone**, establishing IBC as India's premier recovery vehicle.

Implementation of Four New Labour Codes | 21 November 2025

What happened The Union Government officially notified the nationwide enforcement of the **Four New Labour Codes** with effect from **21 November 2025**, culminating the consolidation and rationalisation of **29 legacy central labour enactments**.

The Four Consolidated Codes 1. **The Code on Wages, 2019** (subsumes Payment of Wages Act 1936, Minimum Wages Act 1948, Payment of Bonus Act 1965, Equal Remuneration Act 1976). 2. **The Industrial Relations Code, 2020** (subsumes Trade Unions Act 1926, Industrial Employment Standing Orders Act 1946, Industrial Disputes Act 1947). 3. **The Code on Social Security, 2020** (subsumes Employees' Provident Funds Act 1952, ESI Act 1948, Maternity Benefit Act 1961, Payment of Gratuity Act 1972, etc.). 4. **The Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions (OSH) Code, 2020** (subsumes Factories Act 1948, Mines Act 1952, Contract Labour Act 1970, Inter-State Migrant Workmen Act 1979, etc.).

Key High-Yield Prelims Provisions - **Universal Minimum Wage & National Floor Wage**: Mandatory statutory right across all organized and unorganized employment sectors. - **Mandatory Appointment Letters**: Obligatory for all employees across every establishment, formalizing contractual employment. - **Social Security for Gig & Platform Workers**: First-ever statutory recognition and establishment of a dedicated Social Security Fund financed by aggregators (1–2% of turnover, capped at 5% of payout to workers). - **Preventive Healthcare**: Free annual health check-ups mandated for employees above 40/45 years of age in hazardous establishments. - **Ease of Compliance**: Single electronic registration, single unified license, and single integrated annual return replacing dozens of fragmented returns.

---

10 Years of Unified Payments Interface (UPI) | 2016–2026

What happened The **Unified Payments Interface (UPI)** completed **10 years of transformative operations in April 2026**, having reshaped India's financial architecture into the global gold standard for instant real-time retail payments.

Milestone Timeline & Architecture - **Pilot Launch Date**: **11 April 2016** (launched by Dr. Raghuram Rajan, then RBI Governor, alongside NPCI). - **Umbrella Architect**: **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)** (MD & CEO: Dilip Asbe; non-profit

institution under Section 8 of Companies Act 2013, initiated by RBI and IBA under Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007). - **Core Technology**: 24/7 instant inter-bank payment system using Virtual Payment Address (VPA / UPI ID), QR codes, and phone numbers over IMPS rails.

Record Volumes & Global Dominance (FY 2025–26 Data) - **Monthly Record**: Single-month transaction volume breached **2,264 crore (22.64 billion)** transactions in March 2026. - **Annual Volume & Value (FY 2025–26)**: - Total Annual Transactions: **24,161.69 crore transactions**. - Total Annual Value: Reached approximately **₹314 lakh crore** (~$3.8 trillion). - **Domestic Share**: UPI commands over **85% of total retail digital payment transactions** by volume in India. - **Global Share**: India accounts for approximately **49% of all global real-time payment transactions**, predominantly powered by UPI. - **Cross-Border Footprint**: UPI linked with international payment systems in Singapore (PayNow), UAE (Jaywan/AANI), Mauritius, Sri Lanka, France (Eiffel Tower), Bhutan, and Nepal.

New Income-tax Act, 2025 | Effective 1 April 2026

What happened Parliament enacted the **Income-tax Act, 2025** during the Winter Session 2025, overhauling the six-decade-old Income-tax Act, **1961**. The new legislation officially enters into force on **1 April 2026**.

Key Architectural & Procedural Reforms - **Structural Simplification**: Stripped down complex legacy provisos into **536 sections and 23 chapters** (down from over 800 convoluted provisions in the 1961 Act). - **Abolition of Assessment Year / Previous Year Dichotomy**: Introduced a single, intuitive concept of **"Tax Year"** (Financial Year in which income is earned), ending decades of procedural confusion. - **Form 130 Replaces Form 16**: Standard certificate for deduction of tax at source (TDS) on salary income, traditionally known as **Form 16, is superseded by Form 130** under the new rules. - **New Tax Regime Slabs & Rebates**: - Full tax rebate granted for taxable income up to **₹12,00,000 (₹12 lakh)** under the default New Tax Regime (zero effective tax liability). - Standard Deduction for salaried employees and pensioners retained at **₹75,000**. - Family pension standard deduction: ₹25,000. - **Tax Administration Collections**: Gross direct tax collections surpassed ₹22.27 lakh crore; net direct tax collections registered ~₹19.6 lakh crore.

16th Finance Commission Report (2026–2031) | Award Period 2026–27 to 2030–31

What happened The **Sixteenth Finance Commission (16th FC)** submitted its comprehensive recommendations report to President Droupadi Murmu on **17 November 2025**, which was officially tabled in Parliament on **1 February 2026** alongside the Union Budget 2026–27.

Constitutional Setup & Composition - **Constitutional Provision**: Constituted under **Article 280** of the Constitution of India (notified on 31 December 2023). - **Chairman**: **Dr. Arvind Panagariya** (former Vice Chairman, NITI Aayog; Professor at Columbia University). - **Members**: Ajay Narayan Jha, Annie George Mathew, Dr. Niranjan Rajadhyaksha, Soumya Kanti Ghosh; Secretary: Ritvik Ranjanam Pandey. - **Award Period**: 5 Financial Years from **1 April 2026 to 31 March 2031 (2026–27 to 2030–31)**.

Devolution Formula & Weightages - **Vertical Devolution**: Retained at **41%** of the net divisible pool of Union taxes to States (maintaining parity with the 15th Finance Commission post-reorganisation of Jammu & Kashmir). - **Horizontal Devolution Criteria & Weightages**: - **Income Distance**: **42.5%** (equity criterion measuring distance from highest per-capita income state). - **Population (2011 Census)**: **17.5%**. - **Demographic Performance**: **10.0%** (incentivizing TFR reduction and population stabilization). - **Geographical Area**: **10.0%**. - **Forest & Ecology**: **10.0%** (dense forest canopy cover). - **Contribution to Real GDP / Economic Performance**: **10.0%** (rewarding efficiency and tax base expansion).

Criterion	15th FC Weight	16th FC Weight (2026–31)
Income Distance	45.0%	**42.5%**
Population (2011)	15.0%	**17.5%**
Demographic Performance	12.5%	**10.0%**
Area	15.0%	**10.0%**
Forest & Ecology	10.0%	**10.0%**
Contribution to Real GDP / Economic Effort	2.5% (Tax effort)	**10.0%** (Economic performance)

Grants-in-Aid Package (Total ~₹9.47 Lakh Crore) - Total Recommended Grants: **₹9,47,000 crore** over the 5-year award period. - **Rural Local Bodies (Panchayati Raj Institutions)**: **₹4,35,000 crore**. - **Urban Local Bodies (ULBs / Municipalities)**: **₹3,56,000 crore**. - **Wastewater Management & Sanitation**: Ring-fenced allocation of **₹56,100 crore** within local body grants. - **Urbanisation Premium**: Special dedicated incentive corpus of **₹10,000 crore** for cities managing rapid planned urbanization. -

Disaster Management Grants: **₹1,56,000 crore**. - **State Disaster Risk Management Fund (SDRMF)**: Combined allocation (SDRF + SDMF) of **₹2,04,401 crore** (Centre : State cost sharing at 75:25 for general states, 90:10 for Himalayan and North-Eastern states).

Top 5 State Shares in the Divisible Pool 1. **Uttar Pradesh**: **17.62%** (**HIGHEST share among all States in India!**) 2. **Bihar**: **9.95%** 3. **Madhya Pradesh**: **7.85%** 4. **Maharashtra**: **6.44%** 5. **Rajasthan**: **5.93%** *(West Bengal ranks 6th with 5.67%).*

Fiscal Consolidation & Debt Path Roadmaps - **Union Government Fiscal Deficit**: Glide path targeted to reduce to **3.5% of GDP by 2030–31** (4.3% in 2026–27). - **State Governments Fiscal Deficit**: Capped at **3.0% of GSDP**, with an additional 0.5% conditional borrowing window linked to power distribution reforms. - **Combined General Government Debt**: Targeted to glide down from **77.3% of GDP (in 2025–26) to 73.1% by 2030–31**.

New National Accounts Series with Base Year 2022–23 | Notified 27 February 2026

What happened On **27 February 2026**, the Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation (MoSPI) officially launched the revised National Accounts Statistics series with **Base Year 2022–23** (updating the decade-old 2011–12 series).

Core Innovations & Recalibrated Growth Rates - **Modern Data Integration**: Incorporates GST Network (GSTN) transaction analytics, MCA-21 electronic registry, Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises (ASUSE), and updated CPI consumption weightages. - **Revised Growth Trajectory (2022–23 Base)**: - FY 2025–26 Real GDP Growth: Estimated at **7.6%** (compared to 7.7% under 2011–12 base). - FY 2025–26 Nominal GDP Growth: Pegged at **8.6%**. - Q3 (Oct–Dec 2025) Growth: Real GDP expanded by **7.8%**; Nominal GDP by **8.9%**.

Key Macroeconomic Indicators 2025–26 Snapshot

- **Consumer Price Index (CPI) Inflation**: Dropped to a 5-year cyclical low of **2.10%** in June 2025 (well within RBI's 4 ± 2% tolerance band).
- **Wholesale Price Index (WPI) Inflation**: Contracted into deflationary territory at **-0.32%** in November 2025.
- **Foreign Exchange Reserves**: Scaled an all-time record peak of **$686.2 billion** in early 2026, providing over 11 months of import cover.
- **Current Account Deficit (CAD)**: Comfortably contained at **1.3% of GDP** in FY 2024–25.
- **Gross Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)**: Registered gross inflows of **$51.8 billion**.

Banking Laws (Amendment) Act, 2025 | Effective 1 August 2025

What happened The **Banking Laws (Amendment) Act, 2025** came into force on **1 August 2025**, amending five major banking statutes: Reserve Bank of India Act 1934, Banking Regulation Act 1949, State Bank of India Act 1955, Banking Companies (Acquisition and Transfer of Undertakings) Acts 1970 and 1980.

Key High-Yield Amendments - **Substantial Interest Limit Enhanced**: The monetary threshold defining "substantial interest" in a company/firm for bank directors was **raised from ₹5 lakh to ₹2 crore** (the first revision since 1968, correcting for 57 years of economic expansion). - **Tenure of Directors in Cooperative Banks**: Maximum tenure of directors (other than Chairman/Whole-time Director) in Primary Cooperative Banks capped at **10 consecutive years** (up from 8 years). - **Nomination Facility Multiplied (Max 4 Nominees)**: - **Bank Deposit Accounts**: Depositors can now nominate up to **4 nominees**, either *successively* (in order of priority) or *simultaneously* (with specified percentage shares of deposits). - **Safe Deposit Lockers / Safe Custody Articles**: Up to **4 nominees** allowed *successively*. - **Standardized Reporting Fortnights**: Statutory reporting day for banks changed from alternate Fridays to fixed calendar fortnights: **1st to 15th** of the month and **16th to the end of the month**. - **Investor Protection**: Unclaimed dividends, matured deposits, and interest on shares transferred to the **Investor Education and Protection Fund (IEPF)**.

M. S. Sahoo Committee on Assured Payouts in NPS | PFRDA, 13 January 2026

What happened The Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA) constituted a **15-member high-level committee** on **13 January 2026** chaired by **Dr. M. S. Sahoo** (former Chairperson of Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India - IBBI).

Terms of Reference - Mandated to design and structure the regulatory and operational framework for **"Assured Payouts / Guaranteed Returns"** schemes under the **National Pension System (NPS)**. - Seeks to provide market-linked pension subscribers an optional guaranteed minimum return floor without compromising fiscal sustainability.

Updated Poverty Estimates 2025 (Rangarajan Methodology)

What happened The Department of Economic and Policy Research (DEPR), Reserve Bank of India, published a research paper in 2025 applying the **Dr. C. Rangarajan Committee poverty methodology (2014)** to the official *Household Consumption Expenditure Survey (HCES) 2022–23*.

Key Dramatic Poverty Reductions (2011–12 to 2022–23) - **Rural Odisha**: Rural poverty plunged from **47.8% in 2011–12 down to 8.6% in 2022–23** (a massive 39.2 percentage point decline). - **Urban Bihar**: Urban poverty dropped sharply from **50.8% in 2011–12 down to 9.1% in 2022–23** (a 41.7 percentage point decline). - **Lowest Decline**: States with already low baseline poverty like **Kerala and Himachal Pradesh** recorded the smallest percentage point declines.

MoSPI Mascot & Regional Rural Banks (RRB) Corporate Identity

- **MoSPI Official Mascot & Logo**: On **1 January 2026**, the Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation unveiled its revamped official logo and launched a dedicated mascot named **"सांख्यिकी" (Sankhyiki)** to popularize official statistical literacy and data awareness among Indian citizens and students.
- **RRBs Unified Corporate Identity**: On **18 December 2025**, the Department of Financial Services (DFS) launched a unified national corporate identity and logo for all **Regional Rural Banks (RRBs)** across India, styled in **dark blue and green hues** symbolizing institutional trust, financial stability, and agricultural vitality.

Nutritional Intake in India | NSO Report (HCES 2022–24)

What happened The National Statistical Office (**NSO**), MoSPI, released the report on *Nutritional Intake in India* based on two consecutive rounds of Household Consumption Expenditure Surveys (**HCES 2022–23 and 2023–24**) covering August 2022 to July 2024.

Key Calorie, Protein & Fat Metrics - **Average Daily Calorie Intake**: - 2022–23: **2,233 kcal** (Rural) and **2,250 kcal** (Urban). - 2023–24: **2,212 kcal** (Rural) and **2,240 kcal** (Urban). - Indicates stable average energy intake in the **2,200–2,250 kcal/day** band. - **Fractile Class Convergence**: - Calorie intake in bottom 5 fractile classes in rural and bottom 6 in urban increased in 2023–24 compared to 2022–23. - In 2023–24: Top 5% fractile consumed **2,941 kcal** (Rural) and **3,092 kcal** (Urban); Bottom 5% consumed **1,688 kcal** (Rural) and **1,696 kcal** (Urban) — reflecting a narrowing consumption gap. - **Dietary Shift in Protein & Fat Sources**: - Daily protein intake rose to **61.8 g** (Rural) and **63.4 g** (Urban) in 2023–24 (up from 59.3 g and 58.8 g in 2009–10). - **Decline in Cereal Dominance**: Cereals' contribution to protein dropped from 60.2% to **45.9% in rural areas**, and from 51.3% to **38.7% in urban areas** since 2009–10. - **Surge in Animal & Diversified Protein**: Egg, fish, and meat contribution rose from 5.9% to **12.4% in rural**, and 7.6% to **14.1% in urban** diets. - **Adjusted Daily Intake (Accounting for Outside Meals/Guests)**: - Adjusted Calories: **2,191 kcal** (Rural) | **2,225 kcal** (Urban). - Adjusted Protein: **61.2 g** (Rural) | **62.9 g** (Urban). - Adjusted Fat: **59.7 g** (Rural) | **69.3 g** (Urban).

Status of Tourist Inflow into India | Ministry of Tourism (11 August 2025)

What happened The Ministry of Tourism released comprehensive official statistics on foreign tourist inflow, foreign exchange earnings, and tourism's contribution to the national economy. With overseas tourism offices rationalized, international tourism marketing is actively spearheaded through **Indian Diplomatic Missions abroad**.

Core Tourism Inflow & Economic Metrics - **Foreign Tourist Arrivals (FTA)**: - 2022: **64.37 lakh** - 2023: **95.21 lakh** - 2024: **99.52 lakh** (~9.95 million / near 1 crore mark). - **Foreign Exchange Earnings (FEE) from Tourism**: - 2022: ₹1,69,917 crore - 2023: ₹2,66,045 crore - 2024 (Revised Estimate): **₹2,93,033 crore**. - **Tourism Sector's Share in India's GDP**: - 2021–22: 1.75% - 2022–23: 5.09% - 2023–24 (Provisional Estimate): **5.22% of National GDP**. - **Top 5 Source Countries for FTA in 2024**: 1. **United States (USA)**: **18,04,586** (18.05 lakh — Rank 1!) 2. **Bangladesh**: **17,50,165** (17.50 lakh — Rank 2!) 3. **United Kingdom (UK)**: **10,22,587** (10.23 lakh — Rank 3!) 4. **Australia**: **5,18,205** (Rank 4) 5. **Canada**: **4,76,273** (Rank 5)

Third Advance Estimates of Agricultural Crops 2025–26 | Released 27 May 2026

What happened Union Minister for Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare **Shivraj Singh Chouhan** released the *Third Advance Estimates of Production of Major Agricultural Crops for 2025–26*. India recorded its **highest-ever foodgrain harvest in history**.

Record Production Figures (2025–26) - **Total Foodgrain Production**: **376.563 million tonnes** (Record; increased by 18.8 million tonnes or **+5.3%** over 2024–25's 357.732 MT). - **Rice**: **154.024 million tonnes** (All-time record; up from 150.184 MT). - **Wheat**: **120.657 million tonnes** (All-time record; up from 117.945 MT). - **Maize / Corn**: **55.093 million tonnes**. - **Shree Anna**

(Millets): **17.584 million tonnes**. - **Nutri and Coarse Cereals**: **74.472 million tonnes**. - **Total Pulses**: - Gram (Chickpea): **12.514 million tonnes**. - Tur / Arhar: **3.592 million tonnes**. - Lentil (Masur): **1.762 million tonnes**. - **Total Oilseeds**: **43.059 million tonnes** (Groundnut: 13.074 MT, Soybean: 12.596 MT). - **Sugarcane**: **500.063 million tonnes** (All-time record; up by 45.45 MT over 454.611 MT). - **Cotton**: **29.024 million bales** (Each cotton bale weighs **170 kg**). - **Jute & Mesta**: **9.176 million bales** (Each jute bale weighs **180 kg**).

Top 3 Producing States by Major Crop (Third Advance Estimates 2025–26)

Crop / Category	Rank 1 State	Rank 2 State	Rank 3 State
Rice	**Uttar Pradesh** (198.05 L t)	Telangana (185.29 L t)	West Bengal (171.36 L t)
Wheat	**Uttar Pradesh** (358.77 L t)	Madhya Pradesh (264.43 L t)	Punjab (170.79 L t)
Maize	**Madhya Pradesh** (100.49 L t)	Karnataka (65.51 L t)	Maharashtra (56.97 L t)
Total Pulses	**Madhya Pradesh** (53.48 L t)	Maharashtra (50.79 L t)	Rajasthan (44.73 L t)
Total Oilseeds	**Rajasthan** (105.96 L t)	Gujarat (89.35 L t)	Madhya Pradesh (82.40 L t)
Sugarcane	**Uttar Pradesh** (2,296.99 L t)	Maharashtra (1,316.49 L t)	Karnataka (572.88 L t)
Cotton	**Maharashtra** (77.55 L bales)	Gujarat (67.93 L bales)	Telangana (55.54 L bales)
Jute	**West Bengal** (75.93 L bales)	Bihar (7.59 L bales)	Assam (6.93 L bales)

Minimum Support Prices (MSP) for 14 Kharif Crops 2026–27 | CCEA, 13 May 2026

What happened The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (**CCEA**) chaired by PM Narendra Modi approved the MSP for **14 mandated Kharif crops** for the 2026–27 marketing season, adhering to the principle of setting MSP at **at least 1.5 times the all-India weighted average cost of production ($A2+FL$)**.

Approved Kharif MSP Rates for 2026–27 (₹ per Quintal)

Crop	MSP 2026–27 (₹/qtl)	Absolute Increase (₹/qtl)	Margin over Cost (%)
Paddy (Common)	**₹2,441**	₹141	50%
Paddy (Grade A)	**₹2,461**	₹141	—
Jowar (Hybrid)	**₹4,023**	₹252	50%
Jowar (Maldandi)	**₹4,073**	₹252	—
Bajra	**₹2,900**	₹125	**56%**
Ragi	**₹5,205**	₹419	50%
Maize	**₹2,410**	₹185	**56%**
Tur / Arhar	**₹8,450**	₹450	50%
Moong	**₹8,780**	₹202	**61%** (Highest margin!)
Urad	**₹8,200**	₹450	50%
Groundnut	**₹7,517**	₹434	50%
Sunflower Seed	**₹8,343**	**₹622** (Highest increase!)	50%
Soybean (Yellow)	**₹5,708**	₹316	50%
Sesamum (Til)	**₹10,346** (Highest absolute MSP!)	**₹500**	50%
Nigerseed	**₹10,052**	**₹515**	50%
Cotton (Medium)	**₹8,267**	**₹557**	50%
Cotton (Long)	**₹8,667**	**₹557**	50%

Key Prelims Takeaways: - **Highest Absolute MSP**: **Sesamum (₹10,346/qtl)**, followed by Nigerseed (₹10,052/qtl). - **Highest Absolute Increase**: **Sunflower Seed (+₹622/qtl)**, followed by Cotton (+₹557/qtl) and Nigerseed (+₹515/qtl). - **Highest Profit Margins over Cost**: **Moong (61%)**, **Bajra (56%)**, and **Maize (56%)**.

Basic Animal Husbandry Statistics (BAHS) 2025 | Released 26 November 2025

What happened On **National Milk Day (26 November 2025)**, the Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying released the *Basic Animal Husbandry Statistics 2025* based on the Integrated Sample Survey (ISS 2024–25).

Macroeconomic Weight of Livestock - Livestock sector contributed **31% of total Agricultural GVA** and **5.5% of National GVA** in 2023–24. - Total livestock exports reached **₹66,249 crore** in 2024–25 (dominated by bovine meat). - **Milk Production (India #1 Globally)**: - National Production: **247.87 million tonnes** (+3.58% growth). - **Per Capita Availability**: **485 grams per day** (up from 319 g/day in 2014–15). - **Top 5 Milk Producing States**: 1. **Uttar Pradesh**: **15.66%** 2. **Rajasthan**: **14.82%** 3. **Madhya Pradesh**: **9.12%** 4. **Gujarat**: **7.78%** 5. **Maharashtra**: **6.71%** *(Top 5 states produce 54.09% of India's milk).* - **Egg Production (India #2 Globally)**: - National Production: **149.11 billion eggs** (+4.44% growth). - **Per Capita Availability**: **106 eggs per annum** (up from 62 in 2014–15). - Commercial poultry accounts for **84.49%** of total egg production. - **Top Egg Producing States**: 1. **Andhra Pradesh (18.37%)**, 2. Tamil Nadu (15.63%), 3. Telangana (12.98%), 4. West Bengal (10.72%), 5. Karnataka (6.67%). - **Meat Production (India #4 Globally)**: - National Production: **10.50 million tonnes** (+2.46% growth). Poultry constitutes ~**50%** of total meat. - **Top Meat Producing States**: 1. **West Bengal (12.46%)**, 2. **Uttar Pradesh (12.20%)**, 3. Maharashtra (11.57%), 4. Andhra Pradesh (10.84%), 5. Telangana (10.49%). - **Wool Production**: - National Production: **34.57 million kg** (+2.63% growth). - **Top Wool Producing States**: 1. **Rajasthan (47.85%)**, 2. Jammu & Kashmir (22.88%), 3. Gujarat (6.22%).

Startup India Completes 10 Years & States' Startup Ranking 5.0

What happened The flagship **Startup India** initiative completed **10 years on 16 January 2026** (launched 16 January 2016; **16 January observed as National Startup Day** since 2022). India stands as the **world's third-largest startup ecosystem**.

Key Ecosystem Milestones - Recognized startups expanded from <500 in 2014 to **over 2,00,000 (2 lakh)** in 2026 (~44,000 registered in 2025 alone). - Unicorn count surged from 4 to nearly **125 unicorns**. - **States' Startup Ranking Framework 5.0 (SRF 5.0 by DPIIT)**: - **Best Performers**: **Gujarat** (Category A: >1 crore population); **Arunachal Pradesh & Goa** (Category B: <1 crore). - **Top Performers**: **Uttar Pradesh**, Karnataka, Punjab, and Tamil Nadu (Category A); Himachal Pradesh (Category B). - **Leaders**: Andhra Pradesh, Haryana, Kerala, MP, Maharashtra, Rajasthan, Telangana, Uttarakhand (Category A); Manipur, Meghalaya, Nagaland (Category B).

Semiconductor Manufacturing: India's 1st Commercial Fab & ISM Expansion

What happened India achieved historic breakthroughs in its domestic semiconductor fabrication journey under the **India Semiconductor Mission (ISM)**: 1. **India's First Commercial Semiconductor Fab at Dholera SEZ (Gujarat)**: - Developer: **Tata Semiconductor Manufacturing Private Limited (TSMPL)**. - Officially notified on **9 April 2026**; spread across **66.166 hectares**. - Proposed Outlay: **₹91,000 crore**; projected employment for **21,000 personnel**. - Capacity: **50,000 wafer starts per month** (AI-enabled commercial chip fabrication). 2. **Two New ISM Semiconductor Units Cleared (5 May 2026)**: - Cumulative Investment: **₹3,936 crore** (2,230 high-skilled jobs). - **Crystal Matrix Ltd (Dholera, Gujarat)**: India's first commercial Mini/Micro-LED display facility using **Gallium Nitride (GaN)** foundry technology (annual capacity 72,000 sq. m panels and 24,000 RGB wafer sets). - **Suchi Semicon Pvt Ltd (Surat, Gujarat)**: Outsourced Assembly and Test (OSAT) facility for discrete semiconductors (1,033.20 million chips/year). - **ISM Scale**: Total approved projects under ISM reached **12 projects** with cumulative commitments of **₹1.64 lakh crore**.

Two New SEZs Notified in Puducherry | 27 May 2026

The Ministry of Commerce & Industry notified Puducherry's first two Special Economic Zones: 1. **IT/ITES SEZ**: Developed by **Oulgaret Municipality** at Thattanchavady (8.62 ha; ₹725 cr; 3,500 jobs). 2. **Multi-Sector SEZ**: Developed by **PIPDIC** at Karasur village, Villianur (86.25 ha; ₹1,250 cr; 5,000 jobs).

Electronics & Mobile Manufacturing Surge

- **Electronics Production**: Reached **₹11.3 lakh crore in 2024–25** (6x jump from ₹1.9 lakh cr in 2014–15).
- **Electronics Exports**: Reached **₹3.27 lakh crore** (8x increase); generated **2.5 million jobs** and attracted >USD 4 billion FDI.
- **Top 5 Electronic Export Destinations**: 1. **USA**, 2. **UAE**, 3. **Netherlands**, 4. **UK**, 5. **Italy**.
- **Mobile Phones Leadership**:
- Production scaled 28 times to **₹5.45 lakh crore** in 2024–25; produces **~330 million phones annually**.
- **India is the world's 2nd-largest mobile phone manufacturer**.
- Mobile exports skyrocketed to **₹2 lakh crore** (a 127-fold surge from ₹1,500 cr in 2014–15).

India Foreign Trade Milestones

- **Export Surge**: World Bank notes India's exports expanded at **7.1% (2024)** vs 2.5% global average. Share of exports in India's GDP reached **21.2%**.
- **April–August 2025 Exports**: USD 346.10 billion (merchandise 53.09%, services 46.91%) advancing towards **USD 1 trillion annual export target**.
- **Global Tea Milestone**: In 2024, **India overtook Sri Lanka to become the world's second-largest tea exporter**!

ILO Employment and Social Trends 2026 | Geneva, 14 January 2026

- Released by the **International Labour Organization (ILO)**.
- **Informality**: By 2026, **2.1 billion workers** globally will be in informal employment.
- **Working Poverty**: ~284 million workers globally live on less than USD 3 per day. Extreme working poverty stands at **7.9%**.
- **Global Youth Unemployment**: Recorded at **12.4%** in 2025.
- **Labour Income Share**: Fell to **52.6%** globally.

Global Unicorn Index 2025 | Hurun Research Institute (26 June 2025)

- Highlights **1,523 unicorns worldwide** across **52 countries and 307 cities**, commanding a combined valuation of **$5.6 trillion**.
- Over **55% of global unicorns** were founded in the last 10 years.
- 203 new unicorns emerged during the year, adding $565 billion in new value.

Forbes World's Billionaires List 2026 & Indians in Global Top 100

Global Top 5 Richest Persons: 1. **Elon Musk**: **$839 billion** (Tesla, SpaceX — USA) 2. **Larry Page**: **$257 billion** (Google — USA) 3. **Sergey Brin**: **$237 billion** (Google — USA) 4. **Jeff Bezos**: **$224 billion** (Amazon — USA) 5. **Mark Zuckerberg**: **$222 billion** (Facebook / Meta — USA)

Indian Billionaires in Global Top 100: - **Mukesh Ambani**: **Rank 21 globally** (**$99.7 billion**) — *Richest person in India and Asia*. - **Gautam Adani**: **Rank 31 globally** (**$63.8 billion**) — *Second richest in India*. - **Savitri Jindal & Family**: **Rank 51 globally** (**$39.1 billion**, Steel) — ***Richest Woman in India***. - **Lakshmi Mittal**: **Rank 70 globally** (**$31.0 billion**, Steel). - **Shiv Nadar**: **Rank 71 globally** (**$30.9 billion**, Software / HCL). - **Cyrus Poonawalla**: **Rank 95 globally** (**$27.0 billion**, Vaccines / Serum Institute of India). - **Dilip Shanghvi**: **Rank 100 globally** (**$25.6 billion**, Pharmaceuticals / Sun Pharma).

Hurun Global Rich List 2026 | Released 10 March 2026

- **Indian Billionaire Count**: India added **57 new billionaires** in 2025–26, elevating the total count to **308 billionaires**!
- **Global Standing**: India solidifies its position as the **world's third-largest billionaire hub** (behind USA and China).
- **Wealth Concentration**: Combined wealth of Indian billionaires rose 10% to **₹112.6 trillion**; average billionaire wealth stands at **₹36,570 crore** (now exceeding China's billionaire average).
- **Top Billionaire Cities**:
- **Mumbai**: India's billionaire capital with **95 billionaires** (+15 added in the year, outpacing New York).
- **Shenzhen**: Crowned Asia's billionaire capital with **132 billionaires**.
- **National Leader**: **Mukesh Ambani** remains India's wealthiest individual.

India–EFTA Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement (TEPA) | In Force 1 October 2025

What happened The landmark **Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement (TEPA)** between India and the four developed nations of the **European Free Trade Association (EFTA — Switzerland, Norway, Iceland, and Liechtenstein)**, signed on 10 March 2024, officially **entered into force on 1 October 2025**.

Core Provisions & Economic Commitments - **First FTA with Developed European Nations**: First trade agreement of its kind signed by India with a developed European bloc. - **14 Comprehensive Chapters**: Covering goods, services, rules of origin, IPR, investment promotion, and sanitary measures. - **Tariff Concessions**: - EFTA offers duty concessions on **92.2% of its tariff lines, covering 99.6% of India's exports** (zero duty on non-agricultural and processed food products). - India offers market access on

82.7% of its tariff lines, covering 95.3% of EFTA exports (sensitivities in dairy, soya, coal, and domestic pharma strictly protected). - **$100 Billion Investment Pledge**: EFTA countries legally committed to facilitate **USD 100 billion in foreign direct investment into India over 15 years**, generating an estimated 1 million direct jobs. - **Gold Import Dynamics**: Over **80% of India's imports from EFTA consist of gold**, which remains insulated from tariff reductions.

India's Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) Inflows in FY 2024–25

What happened Government official estimates confirmed that gross FDI inflows into India rose to **USD 81.04 billion (provisional)** in FY 2024–25, registering a **14% increase** over USD 71.28 billion in FY 2023–24.

Long-Term Trend & Inflow Architecture - Over the 11-year span (2014–2025), India accumulated **USD 748.78 billion in FDI**, marking a **143% surge** over the previous 11 years (2003–14: $308.38B). - **Top Sectoral Recipients of FDI Equity (FY 2024–25)**: 1. **Services Sector**: **19%** of total equity inflows (USD 9.35 billion, up 40.77%). 2. **Computer Software & Hardware**: **16%**. 3. **Trading**: **8%**. - *Manufacturing FDI expanded by 18% to USD 19.04 billion.* - **Top Destination States for FDI Equity**: 1. **Maharashtra**: **39%** of total FDI equity inflows (Dominant #1 recipient). 2. **Karnataka**: **13%**. 3. **Delhi**: **12%**. - **Top Source Countries for FDI Equity**: 1. **Singapore**: **30%** share (Leading investing nation). 2. **Mauritius**: **17%** share. 3. **United States (USA)**: **11%** share.

APEDA BHARATI Initiative | Agri-Export Acceleration (2 September 2025)

- Launched by the **Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA)**.
- **BHARATI** stands for: **Bharat's Hub for Agritech, Resilience, Advancement and Incubation for Export Enablement**.
- Nurtures **100 agri-food and agri-tech startups** in its initial batch to propel India's agri-exports toward the national target of **$50 billion by 2030**.

NABARD 8th Rural Economic Conditions and Sentiments Survey (RECSS)

- Conducted by **NABARD** in **November 2025** across 6,000 households in 600 villages across 28 states & 1 UT.
- **79.2% of households** reported higher consumption, spending **67.30% of income on consumption**.
- Credit channels: **58.30%** accessed only formal credit; **20.82%** relied solely on informal sources (average informal interest rate: **17.8%**).
- Government welfare transfers contributed **~10% of rural household income**.
- **Rural roads (42.4%)** emerged as the top perceived infrastructure improvement.

Income Mobility in India (2014–2025) | CMIE Household Panel Study

- Analyzed balanced panel data from CMIE Consumer Pyramids Household Survey across Top 10%, Middle 40%, and Bottom 50%.
- Households experiencing downward mobility rose from 14% (2015) to **26.8% in 2025**; upward mobility rose from 14.1% to **23.5%**.
- Highest vulnerability observed in rural households, with **29% of rural households worse off than in 2014**.

High-Yield Short Economic & Financial News

- **Prohibition of Sugar Exports**: Directorate General of Foreign Trade (**DGFT**) prohibited the export of sugar with immediate effect until **30 September 2026**, reclassifying sugar from the "Restricted" to the **"Prohibited"** category to safeguard domestic price stability.
- **India's First Mega Greenfield Shipyard (Thoothukudi, Tamil Nadu)**: Tripartite MoU inked on **20 April 2026** between **HD Korea Shipbuilding & Offshore Engineering**, National Shipbuilding & Heavy Industries Park TN Ltd (**V.O. Chidambaranar Port Authority** + SIPCOT), and Sagarmala Finance Corporation.
- **First Digital Grievance Redressal for Gig Workers**: **Karnataka** became India's first state to roll out a dedicated digital grievance redressal mechanism under the Karnataka Platform Based Gig Workers Welfare Board.
- **SARTHAK-PDS Scheme Approved**: CCEA approved the technology-driven modernization scheme on **27 May 2026** with a central outlay of **₹25,530 crore**, aligned with the 16th Finance Commission cycle (up to 31 March 2031).
- **Startup India Fund of Funds 2.0 (FoF 2.0)**: Notified on **13 April 2026** with a fresh corpus of **₹10,000 crore** to catalyze domestic venture capital for deep-tech and growth-stage startups.

- **CBDC (Digital Rupee) in Public Distribution System**: RBI's Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC) integrated into food subsidy distribution under PMGKAY via pilots launched in **Gujarat (15 February 2026)** and **Puducherry (26 February 2026)**.

RBI PRAVAAH portal

What it is PRAVAAH = **Platform for Regulatory Application, Validation And AutHorisation** — RBI's central web portal for regulatory authorisations, licences, and approvals.

Core facts

- Launched **28 May 2024**; from **1 May 2025**, regulated entities are told to use PRAVAAH for such applications.
- Covers NBFC registration / Certificate of Registration workstreams and other RBI permissions.
- Portal: `pravaah.rbi.org.in`.
- Confused portals: **e-Kuber** (payments/settlement), **DAKSH** (RBI supervisory), **UDGAM** (unclaimed deposits) — not PRAVAAH.

BSNL Ratna classification

- **BSNL** is classified as a **Miniratna Category-I** CPSE in standard DPE lists used for prelims.
- Do not upgrade it to **Navratna** or **Maharatna** unless a fresh DPE order says so. Recent Navratna upgrades in coverage went to names such as **NHPC, SECI, RailTel, SJVN**, not BSNL.
- **Kerala Declared 'Extreme Poverty-Free' State**: On **1 November 2025 (Kerala Piravi)**, CM Pinarayi Vijayan declared Kerala as India's **first state to eradicate extreme poverty**.
- **India–MERCOSUR PTA Expansion**: Bilateral negotiations initiated on **16 October 2025** to expand the 2009 Preferential Trade Agreement from 450 tariff lines toward a comprehensive trade agreement targeting **$20 billion bilateral trade by 2030**.
- **IPPB Wins Digital Payments Award 2024–25**: **India Post Payments Bank (IPPB)** clinched the **1st position among all Payments Banks in India** in the DFS Performance Index.
- **S&P Sovereign Credit Rating Upgrade to 'BBB'**: On **14 August 2025**, S&P Global Ratings upgraded India's sovereign rating from 'BBB-' to **'BBB'** (short-term rating raised to 'A-2', outlook Stable), marking **India's first sovereign credit upgrade in 18 years (since 2007)** on the back of sustained 8.8% average GDP expansion.
- **India Elected Co-Chair of UN-GGIM-AP (2025–28)**: India elected Co-Chair of the UN Regional Committee on Global Geospatial Information Management for Asia and the Pacific, advancing geospatial integration under PM GatiShakti.
- **India Surpasses Brazil to Rank #3 Globally in Renewable Energy Capacity (IRENA 2026)**:
- As per the **Renewable Capacity Statistics 2026** released by the International Renewable Energy Agency (IRENA, based on calendar year 2025 data), India secured the **3rd rank worldwide in installed renewable energy capacity**, overtaking Brazil.
- **Global Leaderboard**:
  1. **China**: 2,258.02 GW
  2. **United States**: 467.92 GW
  3. **India**: 250.52 GW (IRENA RE metric; MNRE domestic metric crossed 282.75 GW by May 2026)
  4. **Brazil**: 228.20 GW
  5. **Germany**: 199.92 GW
  6. **Japan**: 134.53 GW
  7. **Canada**: 110.51 GW - *World Total*: 5,149.28 GW
- **National Power Grid Expansion & Power Sufficiency FY 2025–26 (Ministry of Power / NPP)**:
- **Synchronous Grid Milestone**: India's national power transmission network crossed **5 lakh circuit kilometres (508,535 ckm)** of transmission lines at $\ge 220\text{ kV}$ in January 2026; transformation capacity reached **1,469,041 MVA (about 1,469.04 GVA)** by June 2026.
- Formally recognized by the Ministry of Power as the **world's largest synchronous national grid** (*"One Nation – One Grid – One Frequency"*).
- **Power Sufficiency Milestone (FY 2025–26)**:
  - Total energy requirement: 17,07,493 MU vs energy availability: 17,06,985 MU $\to$ **Energy deficit stood at just 0.03%**!
  - Peak power demand: 2,45,444 MW vs peak demand met: 2,45,416 MW $\to$ **Peak deficit reduced to just 0.01%**!
- **Non-Fossil Milestone**: India achieved the milestone of **50% cumulative electric power installed capacity from non-fossil fuel sources in June 2025** — **five years ahead of the 2030 NDC target** under the Paris Agreement (working towards 500 GW non-fossil by 2030).
- **Installed Capacity Breakdown (National Power Portal, June 2026)**: Total: **543,013.8 MW (543.01 GW)**:

- *Thermal*: 251,489.13 MW (46.3%)
- *Hydro (Large)*: 51,964.66 MW (9.6%)
- *Renewable Energy Sources (RES, excl. large hydro)*: 230,780.01 MW (42.5%) [Wind: 56,807 MW; Solar: >157,000 MW]
- *Nuclear*: 8,780.00 MW (1.6%)

- **Total Electricity Generation FY 2025–26**: **1,847.913 BU**:
  - *Fossil Fuel Generation*: **1,306.951 BU (70.8%)** [Coal: 1,250.19 BU (67.7%), Lignite: 30.32 BU (1.6%), Gas: 26.01 BU (1.4%)].
  - *Non-Fossil Fuel Generation*: **538.970 BU (29.2%)** [Solar: 173.53 BU (9.4%), Hydro: 167.16 BU (9.1%), Wind: 106.09 BU (5.7%), Nuclear: 55.18 BU (3.0%), BioPower: 29.20 BU (1.6%), Bhutan import: 7.81 BU (0.4%)].
  - Solar + Wind combined generated 279.61 BU (15.14% of national electricity generation).
- **Mizoram Ginger Mission (₹189.79 Crore)**:
- Launched by Union Minister for DoNER Jyotiraditya Scindia and Mizoram CM Lalduhoma as a ₹189.79 crore convergence-led mission to expand scientific ginger cultivation, organic certification, processing, and value-chain export linkages.

July 2026

India–UK CETA in force | 15 July 2026

What happened India–UK trade deal **CETA** and companion **DCC** both started. Full card → International.

Quick money facts

- About **99%** of Indian goods to UK get duty relief in coverage.
- DCC exemption window: up to **5 years**.

VB-G RAM G finance

- Centre: about **₹95,692 crore**.
- Centre + states: about **₹1.51 lakh crore** first year.
- Five-year aim: about **₹7.5 lakh crore**.
- Most states share: **40%**.
- Full card → Schemes.

Soft GST Day

1 July is **GST Day** in India. GST started on **1 July 2017**.

Late-July Cabinet energy facts

Scheme	Simple meaning	Money / size
Samudra Manthan	Find more oil and gas under the sea	About **₹84,084 crore**
PM Surya Sarovar	Solar panels on water bodies	About **₹5,070 crore**; **5,000 MW** target
PM-KISAN extension	₹6,000 a year to farmers	About **₹3.15 lakh crore** (to 2030–31)

Full easy cards → Schemes.

August 2026

I-Day economy facts

- Semiconductor push: about **7–8** new plants in one–two years.
- Soft link: Semicon 2.0 outlay **₹1,27,500 crore** (Cabinet July; guidelines notified around end-August) — full card → Schemes.
- Nuclear capacity aim: **100 GW by 2047**.
- AI skilling for **1 crore** youth.
- Lakhpati Didi target: **6 crore**.
- Full card → Schemes.

MMDR Amendment Act, 2026 | mineral taxation framework

What happened Parliament's **Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Act, 2026** tightened the fiscal framework for minerals. Coverage stressed a more uniform national approach after earlier Supreme Court mineral-tax debates.

Easy facts

- Parent Act being amended: **MMDR Act, 1957**.
- Core idea: States cannot levy fresh taxes/cess on mineral rights / mineral-bearing land except under conditions set by the **Centre**.
- Aim in PIB-style notes: stable mineral taxation, support for critical minerals, lower input-cost uncertainty.
- Soft link: National Critical Mineral Mission (approved earlier, outlay about **₹16,300 crore** to FY31) remains a related minerals push — do not merge the two names.

> **Easy wrong options**

Saying states gained unlimited new mineral-tax power under the 2026 amendment. Calling MMDR a labour law.

Soft SVAMITVA memory from the speech

I-Day coverage recalled about **3.25 crore** families helped and assets worth about **₹140 lakh crore** unlocked under **SVAMITVA** using drones.

September 2026

57th GST Council meeting shifted | process reforms next

What happened The **57th GST Council** meeting, earlier linked to mid-September, was moved to **7 October 2026** in New Delhi. The shift matched India's hosting of the **BRICS Leaders' Summit** (12–13 September).

What you should remember

- Chair: Union Finance Minister (**GST Council Chairperson**).
- October agenda stress in official messaging: **process reforms** under **GST 2.0** (e-invoicing, invoice matching, input-tax-credit issues) — **not** a fresh broad rate-cut round.
- Rate rationalisation was the earlier big slab story (teaching: simplified principal slabs after the 2025 rate exercise).
- Soft forward link: Officers' meetings before the Council (early October window in coverage).

> **Trap**

Do not say the Council met on **12 September 2026** and cut rates again. That date was BRICS week; the Council moved to **October**.

October 2026

CCEA Clears Minimum Support Prices (MSP) for Rabi Crops

What happened The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA), chaired by Prime Minister **Narendra Modi**, approved the **Minimum Support Prices (MSP)** for all mandated **Rabi crops** for the upcoming marketing season to safeguard farm income and ensure food security.

Core specs & return over cost board

Mandated Rabi Crop	Approved MSP (₹/q)	Absolute Hike (₹/q)	Cost of Production (₹/q)	Return over Cost (%)
Wheat (गेहूँ)	**₹2,425**	**₹150**	₹1,128	**115%**
Rapeseed & Mustard (सरसों)	**₹5,950**	**₹300** *(Highest hike)*	₹3,005	**98%**
Barley (जौ)	**₹1,980**	**₹130**	₹1,238	**60%**
Gram / Chana (चना)	**₹5,650**	**₹210**	₹3,531	**60%**

Mandated Rabi Crop	Approved MSP (₹/q)	Absolute Hike (₹/q)	Cost of Production (₹/q)	Return over Cost (%)
Lentil / Masur (मसूर)	**₹6,700**	**₹275**	₹3,545	**89%**
Safflower (कुसुम)	**₹5,940**	**₹140**	₹3,960	**50%**

- **Swaminathan Formula Saturation:** Every single Rabi crop satisfies the statutory norm of providing **at least 50% profit margin** over the all-India weighted average cost of production ($A2 + FL$).
- Highest absolute hike: **Rapeseed & Mustard (+₹300/q)**.
- Highest margin: **Wheat (115%)**.

57th GST Council Meeting | 7 October 2026 | New Delhi

What happened The **57th meeting of the Goods and Services Tax (GST) Council** was held in New Delhi, chaired by Union Finance Minister **Nirmala Sitharaman** and attended by State Finance Ministers.

Core outcomes & GST 2.0 process reforms - **Process Over Rates:** The Council focused squarely on **process simplifications, ease of compliance, and fraud prevention (GST 2.0)** rather than broad-scale rate cuts. - **Biometric-Based Aadhaar Authentication:** Approved the phased, nationwide rollout of biometric-based Aadhaar authentication for high-risk GST applicants to eliminate fake firms and bogus Input Tax Credit (ITC) billing. - **Anti-Profiteering Transition:** Formally institutionalised the sunset of the National Anti-Profiteering Authority (NAA), transferring residual consumer cases and monitoring powers to the **Competition Commission of India (CCI)**. - **GoM Mandate on Insurance:** Tasked the Group of Ministers (GoM) on rate rationalisation to finalise tax relief recommendations for health and life insurance premiums.

RBI Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) Review | October 2026

What happened The six-member Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) of the Reserve Bank of India, headed by Governor **Shaktikanta Das**, announced its bi-monthly monetary policy decision.

Key policy rates & strategic stance change - **Policy Repo Rate:** Maintained unchanged at **6.50%** (kept steady for the 10th consecutive meeting). - **Standing Deposit Facility (SDF) Rate:** Unchanged at **6.25%**. - **Marginal Standing Facility (MSF) & Bank Rate:** Unchanged at **6.75%**. - **Crucial Stance Pivot:** The MPC voted 5 to 1 to shift its monetary policy stance from *"withdrawal of accommodation"* to **"Neutral"**. - **Why it matters:** The shift to "Neutral" signals that the rate-hiking cycle has definitively concluded, giving the central bank flexibility to respond to domestic growth needs. - **Growth & Inflation Projections:** Real GDP growth forecast for FY 2024–25 retained at **7.2%**; CPI inflation projected at **4.5%**.

Practice Zone — UPPCS Format

> **20 questions** for this sheet only — drill after you revise the months above. Formats match UPPCS 2024–25: multi-statement, Match List, NOT-matched, A/R, chronology. Full cross-topic index → Practice Zone hub.

Q1. With reference to the Union Budget 2026–27, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It was the first Union Budget prepared in Kartavya Bhawan.
2. The Budget speech projected public capital expenditure of about ₹12.2 lakh crore.
3. The fiscal deficit target announced in the Budget messaging was 5.1% of GDP.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ Show answer

Logic: Budget identity facts — Kartavya Bhawan + Yuva Shakti framing + capex figure. **Ans: A.** (1) and (2) true. (3) false — fiscal deficit fact is **4.3%** of GDP, not 5.1%. Trap: confusing older deficit bands with 2026–27 speech.

Q2. With reference to Union Budget 2026–27 announcements, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. A new Dedicated Freight Corridor idea from Dankuni (East) to Surat (West) was mentioned.
2. Ship-repair support for inland waterways named Varanasi and Patna.

3. Orange Economy / AVGC support referred to Animation, Visual Effects, Gaming and Comics.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Budget transport / Orange Economy facts. **Ans: D.** All three appear in February economy / scheme sheets. Trap: replacing Varanasi with only coastal yards.

Q3. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists.

List-I	List-II
A. Biopharma SHAKTI	1. About ₹20,000 crore / 5 years
B. CCUS (Budget cluster)	2. About ₹10,000 crore / 5 years
C. Cotton Productivity Mission	3. About ₹5,659 crore
D. Coal / lignite gasification	4. About ₹37,500 crore

Row order is not the answer code.

A. 2 1 3 4 B. 2 3 1 4 C. 1 2 3 4 D. 2 1 4 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Match Budget / Cabinet scheme ↔ money. **Ans: A.** Biopharma→2; CCUS→1; Cotton→3; Gasification→4. Trap: swapping Biopharma with Container scheme (also ₹10,000 crore) is fine for money but wrong if stem asks name→outlay without reading List carefully — here money pairs are distinct except remember Container also ₹10k.

Q4. With reference to the sugar export ban reported in May 2026 coverage, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The ban window was locked till 30 September 2026.
2. Coverage linked the decision with monsoon / supply stress fears including El Niño-type risk language.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Sugar export ban window. **Ans: C.** Economy CA soft fact. Trap: shifting end date to 31 March.

Q5. Consider the following and arrange them in correct chronological order:

1. India–UK CETA and DCC enter into force
2. VB-G RAM G comes into force
3. India–Oman CEPA enters into force
4. Union Budget 2026–27 presented

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 4, 3, 2, 1 B. 4, 2, 3, 1 C. 3, 4, 2, 1 D. 4, 3, 1, 2

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Chronology — big scheme / trade dates. **Ans: A.** Budget 1 Feb → Oman CEPA early June → VB-G 1 Jul → UK CETA 15 Jul. Trap: putting CETA before VB-G.

Q6. With reference to tax / Budget law messaging for 2026, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The New Income Tax Act, 2025 comes into force on 1 April 2026.
2. SWM Rules, 2026 also commence on 1 April 2026.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: New Income Tax Act force date. **Ans: C.** Same calendar fact, different subjects — easy “both true” if you revised January + February together.

Q7. With reference to Semicon 2.0, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Outlay ₹1,27,500 crore.
2. Cabinet approval around mid-July 2026.
3. Outlay ₹2,741 crore.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Semicon 2.0 economy fact. **Ans: A.** ₹2741 = UP CAMP.

Q8. With reference to the MMDR Amendment Act, 2026, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It amends the MMDR Act, 1957.
2. States cannot levy fresh mineral-rights taxes except under Centre-set conditions.
3. It gives states unlimited new mineral-tax power.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: MMDR Amendment 2026 core idea. **Ans: A.** (3) opposite.

Q9. Which of the following statements is/are correct for Budget 2026–27?

1. Fiscal deficit target 4.3% of GDP.
2. Capex ₹12.2 lakh crore.
3. Fiscal deficit target 6.4% of GDP.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Fiscal deficit 4.3%. **Ans: A.** Wrong band.

Q10. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. New Income Tax Act, 2025 comes into force 1 April 2026.
2. Finance Act, 2026 gives effect to FY 2026–27 proposals.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: New IT Act 1 April 2026. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q11. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. 1 July is GST Day in India.
2. GST started on 1 July 2017.
3. GST started on 1 April 2017.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: GST Day 1 July. **Ans: A.** 1 July 2017.

Q12. With reference to RELIEF, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. About ₹497 crore package.
2. Supports exporters in conflict risk with ECGC-linked support.
3. It is NBS fertiliser subsidy.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: RELIEF exporters ECGC. **Ans: A.** Scheme collision.

Q13. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. CETA entered force 15 July 2026.
2. About 99% Indian goods get UK duty relief in coverage.
3. DCC is the trade tariff schedule of CETA.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: India–UK CETA 99% duty relief idea. **Ans: A.** DCC = social security.

Q14. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. India–Oman CEPA entered force early June 2026.
2. ~99% duty-free access idea for Indian exports.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Oman CEPA June economy. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q15. With reference to SVAMITVA I-Day recall, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. About 3.25 crore families helped in coverage.
2. Assets worth about ₹140 lakh crore unlocked using drones.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: SVAMITVA I-Day soft numbers. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q16. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Budget mentioned Dankuni (East) to Surat (West) freight corridor idea.
2. 20 new National Waterways over five years.
3. Corridor from Mumbai to Chennai only.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Dankuni–Surat freight corridor. **Ans: A.** (3) wrong.

Q17. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Total expenditure BE messaging ~₹53.5 lakh crore.
2. Centre net tax receipts BE messaging ~₹28.7 lakh crore.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Total expenditure ~53.5 lakh crore BE idea. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q18. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Sugar export ban locked till 30 September 2026.
2. Linked with supply/monsoon stress fears in coverage.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Sugar export ban till 30 Sep. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q19. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. National Critical Mineral Mission outlay about ₹16,300 crore to FY31 in related notes.
2. MMDR Amendment 2026 and NCMM are the same Act.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Critical Mineral Mission soft link with MMDR. **Ans: D.** Related but not same.

Q20. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Budget 2026–27 called a Yuva Shakti-driven Budget.
2. Presented by Nirmala Sitharaman.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Yuva Shakti Budget label. **Ans: C.** Both true.